capital of New Zealand. He was to receive the details for his stay via the diplomatic pouch in a couple of days.

Meanwhile, Kailash Singh, the third member of the band, was working on an alternate plan and safe house. Thrown out of Fiji by the Rabuka regime, Singh wanted revenge. He had arranged for a safe house in Adelaide, South Australia, through an old acquaintance named Max Hamilton and was scheduled to fly there the first week of April 1988.

Shortly before six p.m. on 11 April, a chauffeur driven car pulled into Wisdom road, Greenwich, a peaceful suburb in north Sydney. Kailash and Sahgal emerged to find Malik waiting at the porch. The redesigned colonial house with high ceilings and light filled interiors was going to be the control and command centre of Operation Fiji.

Meanwhile, at the R&AW headquarters, some of the agents believed that the coup and subsequent changes in Fiji were internal matters of that country, and any action by an Indian agency could very well harm and not help the ethnic Indians. Other agents countered that if India did not act for Fiji's Indians, there would be no Indians left there at all. 'In the long run, if India needed to exercise its influence in South Pacific countries, this covert conquest was our only available option,' said Shekhawat.

Malik was the best person to lead the operation because, according to Shekhawat, he loved action and hated paperwork. 'I don't remember if he ever said "no" to an operation,' Shekhawat laughed. 'Once, when he was informed that an enemy element was troubling our operatives in Europe, he only asked for two days to resolve the issue. "If you want to eliminate, just do it, don't make plans," was Malik's favourite